

November

22

Capturing Blackbeard

1718

British Navy lieutenant Robert Maynard and his crew fought the infamous British pirate Blackbeard (below) in an effort to capture him. In the battle, the pirate took five musket shots and 20 cuts by sword before he fell.



Born this day

1984 Scarlett Johansson, US actor. She is well known for playing Black Widow in the Marvel films, and is one of the highest-earning female actors of all time.

Popular leader

2005

Angela Merkel was sworn in as Germany's first female chancellor. She was re-elected to this position in 2009, 2013, and 2018.



Also on this day

1975 Prince Juan Carlos I of the Spanish royal family was declared king of Spain following the death of military dictator Francisco Franco. He transformed Spain into a democracy, and later a constitutional monarchy.

1995 *Toy Story*, the first feature-length computer-animated film, was released by Walt Disney Pictures and Pixar Animation Studio.

1963 National tragedy

As he travelled through Dealey Plaza in Dallas, Texas, USA, John F Kennedy – the 35th president of the USA – was fatally shot by a man named Lee Harvey Oswald.

